



VR headsets are finally going to take gaming into a whole new exciting realm, and it's going to keep everyone from gamers and game developers busy. At the same time, enhanced displays with greater pixel resolution and frame rates will make games pop and leap out of their respective screens!



cal GP100-based 1080 Ti could potentially run as fast as two 980 Tis. 4K/60 FPS gaming on a single card may finally become a reality.

...4K and 120 Hz Gaming Will go Mainstream...

Technically, it's an either-or situation right now, as there are no 4K 120Hz monitors out on the market. However, the Displayport 1.3 standard does support this insanely high refresh rate/resolution combo. Both the Pascal and Polaris lineups this years are expected to support DisplayPort 1.3 and we most certainly will see 4K 120Hz monitors drop later this year. While 120Hz gaming at 4K is out of reach for all but those with the highest-end SLI/CF rigs, this years crop of graphics cards will make 4K/60Hz and 1440p/120Hz experiences feasible at mainstream pricepoints.

The PS4 manages to hit 1080p/60 in just a handful of titles such as Black Ops III. The PS4 Neo's faster GPU may allow it to run games at higher resolutions than this, but CPU-side bottlenecks, courtesy the anaemic Jaguar processor, will likely limit the Neo to more 30 FPS experiences. Both Pascal and Polaris set to bring enormous amount of graphics grunt at mainstream prices. Moreover, 4K monitors (and 4K TVs, for that matter) aren't stratospherically priced anymore; If you don't mind buying off brand, a 42in

Micromax 4K set can be had for under Rs. 38,000. 4K and high framerate gaming will make for some compelling PC experiences this year, without completely nuking your wallet.

...And VR's Actually Going To Be A Thing

While PSVR is certainly a great entry-level proposition for VR gaming, the HTC Vive and Oculus Rift are where you want to be at for an immersive, high-end VR experience. PSVR's main limitation is, well, the PS4. As it's paltry library of 1080p/60 titles shows, the PS4 is really not capable of hitting high framerates at high resolutions in demanding games. With PSVR, Sony's made it clear that 1080p/60 is the bare minimum for games to get certified. While this may be easier to achieve on the PS4 Neo, a major caveat here is that the Neo's developer guidelines allegedly demand platform parity: games can't run solely on the Neo, so any PSVR game out there will need to

hit 1080p/60. On the PS4. This substantially limits the visual scope of PSVR titles. Both the HTC Vive and Oculus Rift call for a GTX 970 minimum. While a 970 is still quite pricey, mainstream Pascal and Polaris cards will likely offer 970 levels of performance with much lower prices of admission later on in the year. Moreover, the irksome screendoor effect is much less of an issue on both PC HMDs than it is on the PSVR's lower-resolution panel.

With the Vive offering room-level tracking and Oculus' upcoming Touch controllers lending you actual ingame hands, the best VR experiences will be on PC.

While the PS4 Neo is certainly good news in the console space, the leap to 14/16nm FinFET and the rise of both 4K and VR gaming undeniably make PC the platform of choice for gaming. While it could be argued that high-end PC gaming's where it's always been at, the PC space has never been as accessible, as exciting as it is right now. *